



Audible Data Cleaning Project

Cleaning & Standardizing an Audible Dataset
Using Excel Power Query



Power Query



Data Cleaning



Data Transformation



Cleaning & Standardizing the Dataset

Using **Power Query Editor in Excel** to clean, standardize, and prepare the Audible dataset for analysis.

01

Name Casing

Standardize the name column to consistent title casing.

02

Author Split

Separate combined names in author when multiple authors are listed.

03

Release Date

Ensure releasedate follows a consistent DD-MM-YYYY format.

04

Time Duration

Convert time from text into an Excel-recognized duration format.

05

Price Numeric

Ensure price is numeric, and identify any non-numeric values.

06

Star Ratings

Convert text ratings in stars into numeric values.

07

Narrator Split

Split narratedby into multiple columns when multiple narrators are listed.

08

Release Info

Merge releasedate and language into "releaseinfo" as "DD-MM-YYYY, Language."

09

Price Format

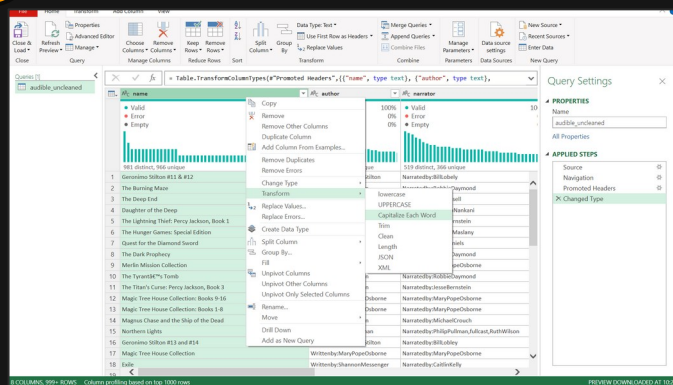
Format all price values consistently to two decimal places.

TASK 01 · NAME COLUMN

Standardizing Book Titles

The name column mixed sentence case, ALL CAPS, and inconsistent styling. Power Query's **Capitalize Each Word** standardized every title — then two **Replace Values** steps fixed an artifact where the letter right after an apostrophe (as in Titan'S) was wrongly capitalized.

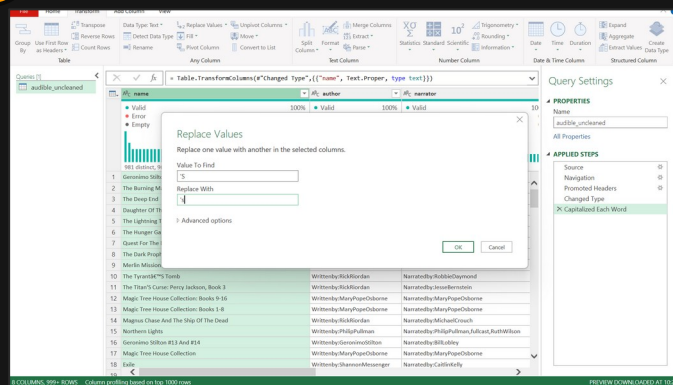
1



Apply Capitalize Each Word

Right-click the name column → Transform → Capitalize Each Word — standardizes casing across all 981 titles.

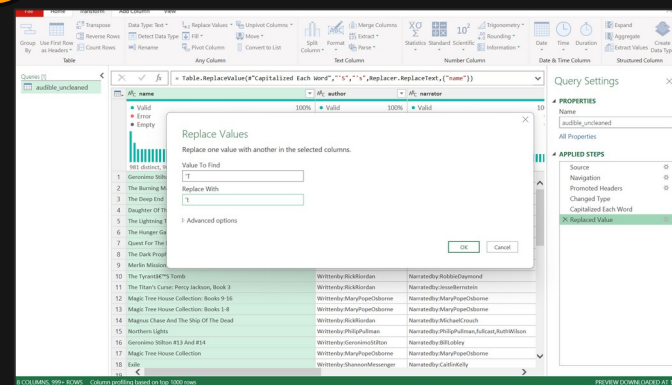
2



Fix the 'S' artifact

Replace Values: 'S' → 's' — corrects possessive casing, e.g. Titan'S → Titan's.

3



Fix the 'T' artifact

Replace Values: 'T' → 't' — corrects the same casing issue after an apostrophe-T.

966

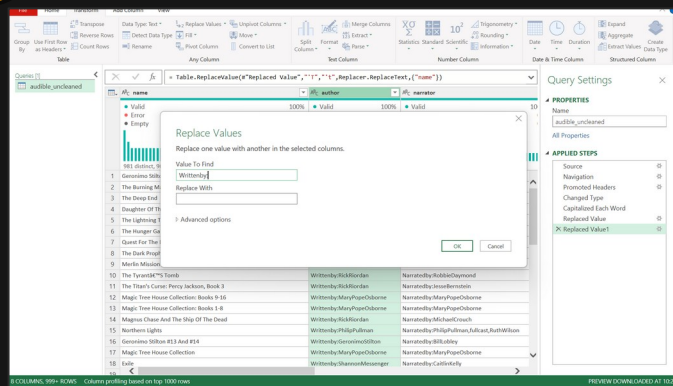
unique titles now in clean, consistent title case — out of 981 distinct raw entries in the source column.

TASK 02 · AUTHOR COLUMN

Splitting Combined Authors

The raw author field carried a “Writtenby:” prefix, with multiple authors comma-separated in one cell. Cleaning stripped the prefix with **Replace Values**, then applied **Split Column by Delimiter** on commas — twice — for books with 3+ co-authors.

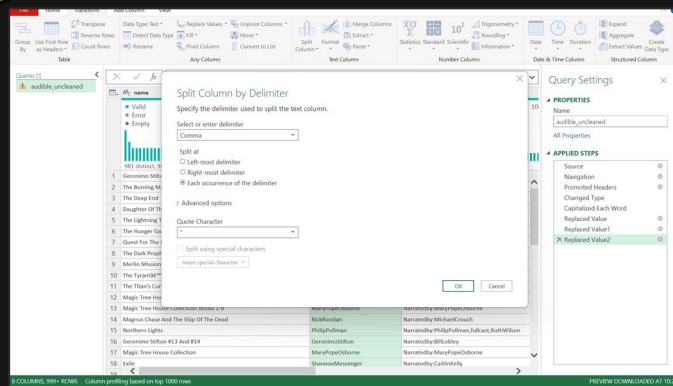
1



Remove the “Writtenby:” prefix

Replace Values: “Writtenby:” → (blank) on the author column — strips the literal text prefix from every entry.

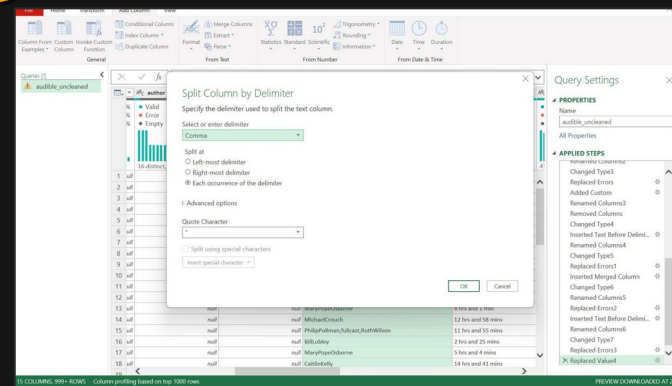
2



Split into author 1 / author 2

Split Column by Delimiter (comma, each occurrence) — separates the first two co-authors into their own columns.

3



Refine split for extra co-authors

A second comma split further down the pipeline catches books with 3+ authors still combined in one column.

16

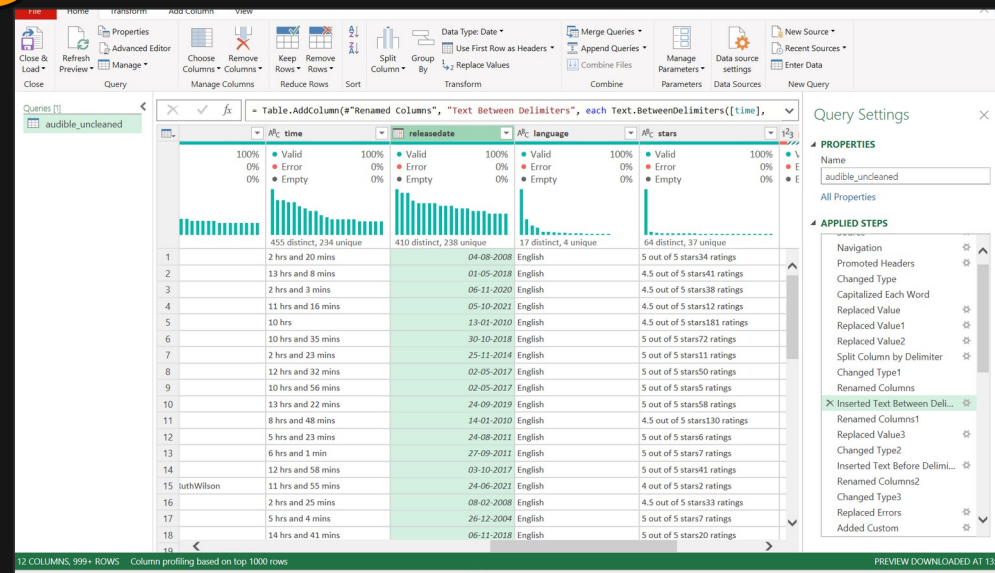
distinct combinations still packed into a single column before the second split fully separated every remaining co-author.

TASK 03 · RELEASE DATE COLUMN

Verifying the Release Date Column

Unlike the other fields, releasedate needed **no corrective transformation** — every value already read cleanly in DD-MM-YYYY order, with **0% errors**.

1



releasedate: clean from the start

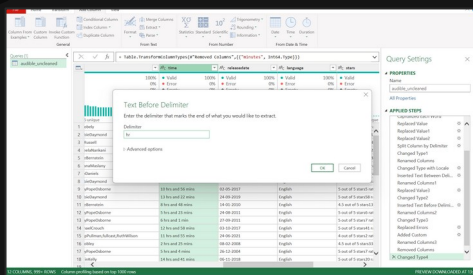
Column statistics confirm 100% valid values and 0% errors, dates already displaying consistently as DD-MM-YYYY. **238** unique release dates, out of 410 distinct raw entries — no fix required.

TASK 04 · TIME COLUMN (PART 1 OF 2)

Parsing Hours & Minutes from Text

The raw time field was a text string like “10 hrs and 56 mins.” Hours came out in one clean pass, but minutes needed **two extraction attempts** — reconciled into a single accurate value with a **Custom Column**.

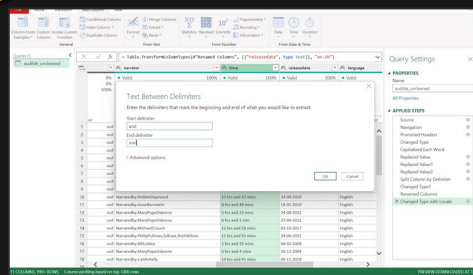
1



Extract the hour number

Text Before Delimiter: “hr” on the time column — pulls the leading number (“10 hrs and 56 mins” → “10”).

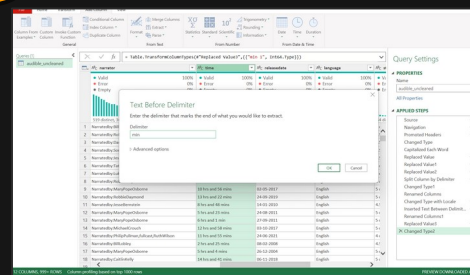
2



Extract minutes — attempt A

Text Between Delimiters: “and” → “min” on the time column — captures the number between the two words.

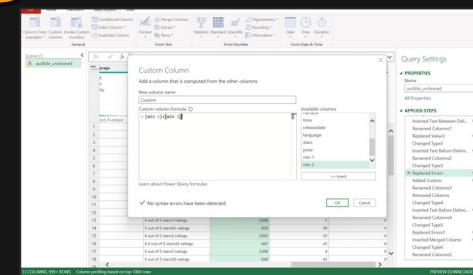
3



Extract minutes — attempt B

Text Before Delimiter: “min” on the time column — a second extraction of the same minutes value.

4



Reconcile into one value

Custom Column: = [min 1] + [min 2] — combines both passes into the final minutes figure.

2

extraction passes reconciled with a Custom Column into one accurate minutes value across all 999+ rows.

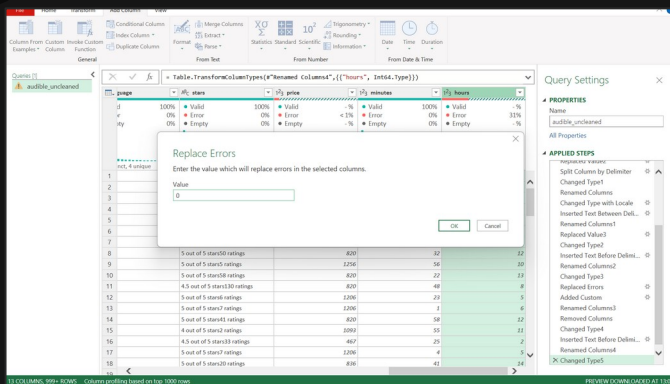


TASK 04 · TIME COLUMN (PART 2 OF 2)

Building the Duration Column

After extraction, the hours column had a **31% error rate** on rows with no valid number — cleared with Replace Errors. Minutes and hours were then merged and converted to a true **Duration** type.

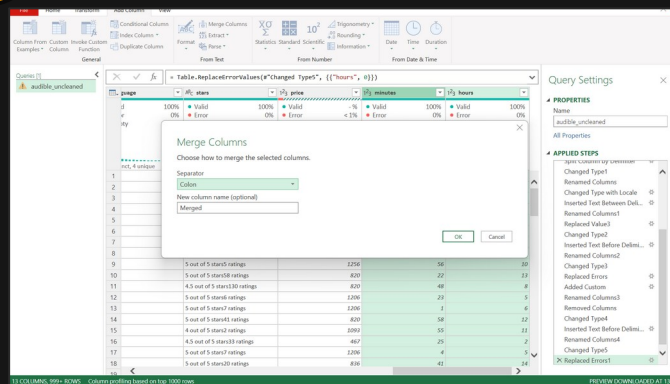
1



Fix hour extraction errors

Replace Errors: 0, applied to the hours column after converting it to a whole number — clears the 31% error rate from rows with no valid hour.

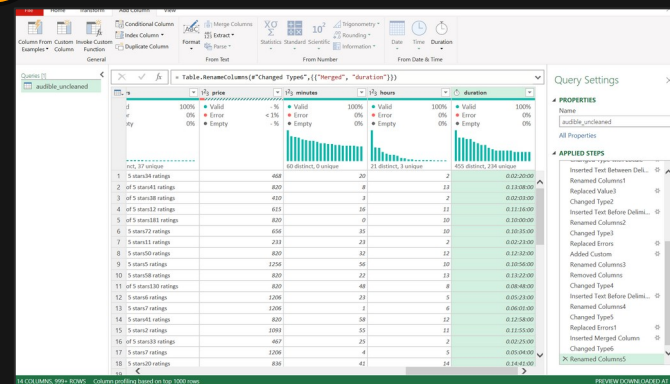
2



Merge minutes : hours

Merge Columns with a colon separator combines the two numeric parts into one HH:MM-style value.

3



Convert to Duration type

The merged column is renamed “duration” and converted to an actual Duration type — free text becomes something Excel can calculate with.

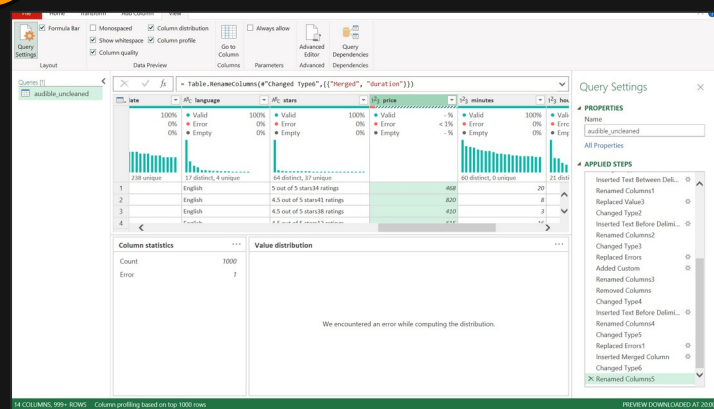
31%

error rate in the extracted hours column, fully resolved before merging into the final duration value.

Catching a Bad Price Value

Converting price to a numeric type surfaced **exactly one row** out of 1000 where the value couldn't parse as a number. A **Replace Errors** step resolved it to 0, making the column fully numeric.

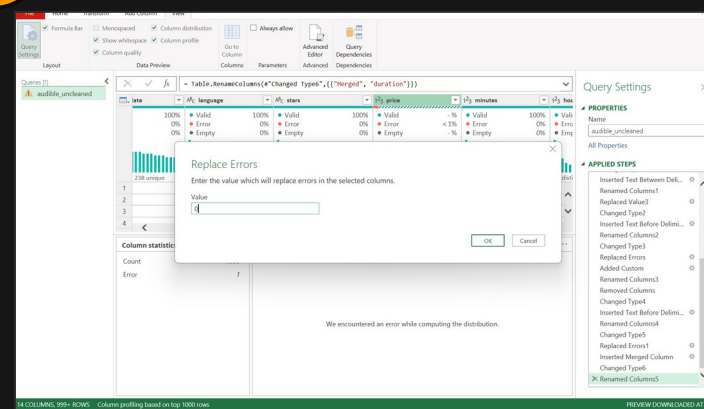
1



Surface the error

With price selected, Column statistics reports 1 error out of 1000 rows — Power Query can't even compute a value distribution until it's resolved.

2



Resolve it

Replace Errors: 0, applied to the price column — the one non-numeric value is replaced so the whole column is usable for calculations.

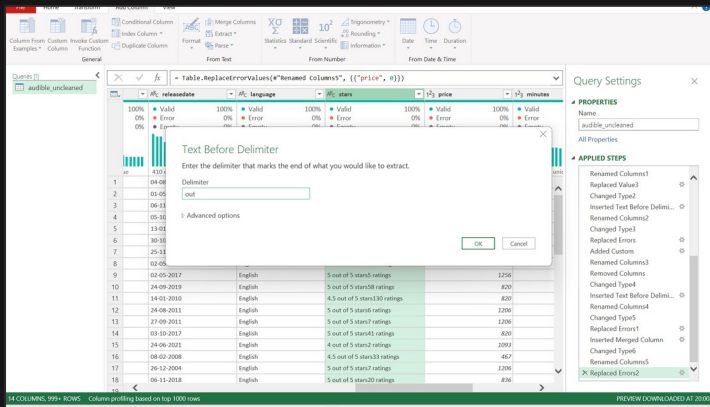
1

non-numeric value found among 1000 price entries — resolved with Replace Errors so the column is fully numeric.

Extracting Star Scores & Rating Counts

The raw stars text bundled two numbers in one string, like “5 out of 5 stars34 ratings.” The star score was pulled out with **Text Before Delimiter**, while the separate ratings-count column had a **76% error rate** resolved with Replace Errors.

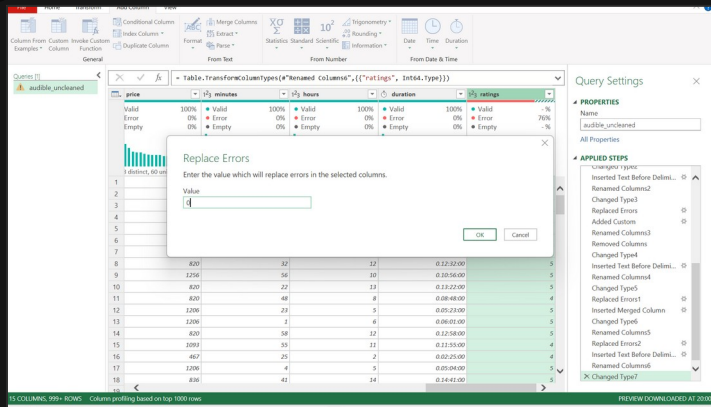
1



Extract the star score

Text Before Delimiter: “out” on the stars column — takes everything before it, e.g. “5 out of 5 stars5 ratings” → “5”.

2



Fix the ratings-count errors

Replace Errors: 0, applied to the ratings column after converting it to a whole number — clears a 76% error rate.

76%

error rate in the extracted ratings-count column, fully resolved with Replace Errors.

Cleaning Up Narrator Names

Like the author field, narrator carried a literal “Narratedby:” prefix and inconsistent casing. Both were cleaned with **Replace Values** and **Capitalize Each Word** before the column was later split the same way authors were.

1

Remove the “Narratedby:” prefix

Replace Values: “Narratedby:” → (blank) on the narrator column — the same fix applied to “Writtenby:” on the author column.

2

Standardize casing

Transform → Capitalize Each Word on the narrator column — applied while it's still one combined field, before it's split.

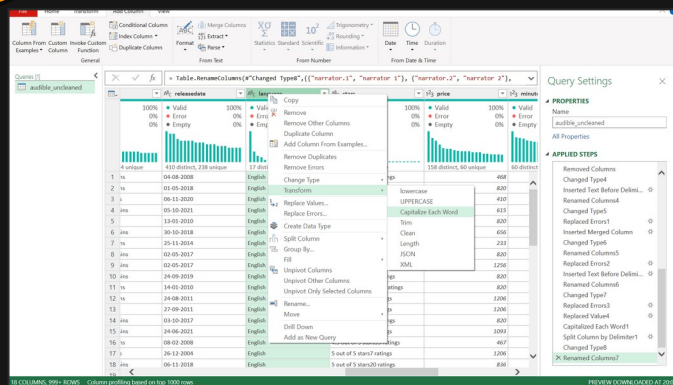
366 unique narrators identified among 519 distinct raw entries, once the prefix and casing were cleaned up.

TASK 08 · RELEASE INFO COLUMN

Merging Date & Language into One Field

The language column was standardized with **Capitalize Each Word**, then merged with the already-cleaned releasedate using a comma separator via **Merge Columns** — producing one combined “release info” field.

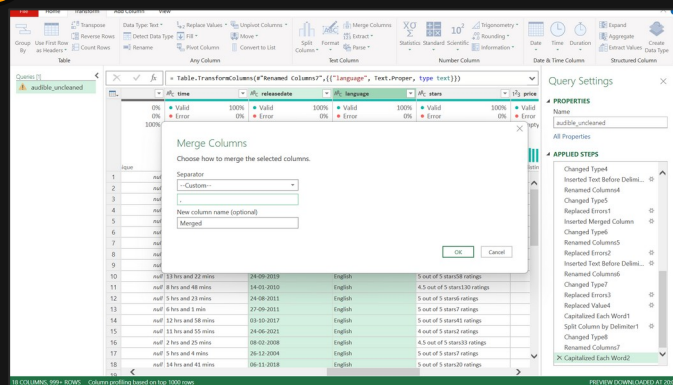
1



Standardize language casing

Transform → Capitalize Each Word on the language column — ensures consistent casing before the merge.

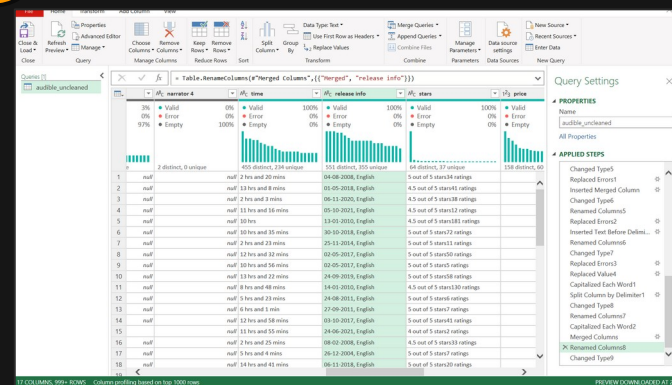
2



Merge with a comma separator

Merge Columns: releasedate + language, custom separator “,” — combined into a new “Merged” column.

3



Rename to “release info”

The merged column is renamed “release info,” producing values like “04-08-2008, English.”

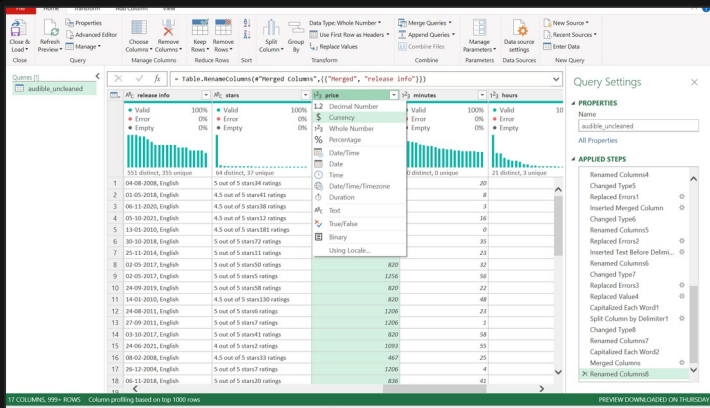
355

unique combinations of date and language, out of 551 distinct release info values across the dataset.

Formatting Price to Two Decimals

After the earlier numeric cleanup, price was converted to a **Currency** data type — formatting every value to a consistent two-decimal display, e.g. “468” → “468.00”.

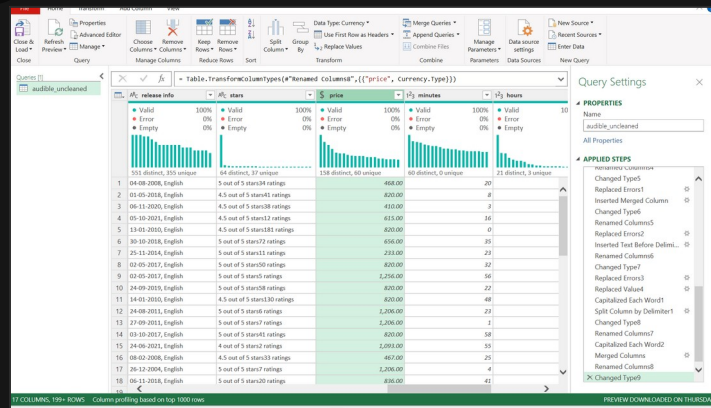
1



Select the Currency type

Data Type dropdown on the price column — Currency selected in place of Whole Number.

2



Consistent two-decimal result

Every price now displays as “468.00,” “820.00,” “1,256.00” — uniform and ready for analysis.

PROJECT COMPLETE



DATA CLEANING PROJECT COMPLETE



01 Name Casing

04 Time Duration

07 Narrator Cleanup

966 Unique Titles

02 Author Split

05 Price Errors

08 Release Info Merge

999+ Rows Cleaned

03 Release Date

06 Star Ratings

09 Price Formatting

355 Release Info Combos

Dataset fully cleaned, structured, and ready for analysis.